

Rentals blocked on rooted phones

If your phone is rooted, you will not be able to rent movies from the Android Market place due to copy protection

Real-time browsing on E ink screen

Bookeen showed off a demo of real time web browsing and scrolling on a standard E-ink screen using custom software



Acer G195HQ won the Best Buy in the 19-inches and under category. It had a good contrast ratio but DisplayMate performance was a bit lacking

19-INCHES AND UNDER

There were plenty of LCD monitors in this segment. These are ideal for entry level users, who don't want to spend a bomb on monitors. Intex, TechCom, Acer, Mercury and NEC monitors were present in this category.

In terms of aesthetics there wasn't much on offer except for the NEC monitor. The NEC MultiSync EA191M is a 19-inch monitor based on the PVA panel and has the sturdiest build among all the other monitors. It has a circular base, a very thick bezel and an adjustable vertical stand. The monitor can swivel across the vertical and horizontal planes by 90 degrees. It's quite heavy though. The on-screen display (OSD) controls were particularly impressive with dedicated buttons and a navigational pad located on the right-hand corner. The function of the controller buttons just above the button on the screen allows you to operate the OSD controls even in the dark. There are many options to play around

with, including various tools for adjusting volume, adjusting black levels, off timer and upto five preset colour settings. It's also the only monitor with a 5:4 screen aspect ratio and a resolution of 1280x1024 whereas all the other monitors in this segment have a 16:9 aspect ratio with a widescreen resolution of 1366x768 pixels.

TechCom SSD-LCD 1805 is an ordinary looking LCD. The round OSD buttons located on the sides, don't have an on-screen indicator. This requires some getting used to, while navigating the OSD. It tends to wobble a lot when nudged slightly, which is not good.

Acer G195HQ is an attractive looking monitor thanks to its X-shaped base stand which has a sharp glossy finish. The design looks very reminiscent of the Alienware monitors. The Digital Visual Interface (DVI) and D-Sub ports are recessed as has been seen in most monitors in this range. The other Acer monitor – the S191HQL is an LED backlit LCD monitor. It's the only monitor with

a reflective screen which is not desirable as it tends to reflect brightly lit objects in the background, which can be distracting for users who have windows bang opposite their monitors.

Mercury 1950TWG is another simple looking monitor with probably the worst looking OSD menu amongst all the monitors that we tested.

Intex has two models in this category, namely the 1810W and 1811W. The latter is an LED backlit LCD monitor whereas the former is a CCFL-backlit LCD monitor. Looks-wise, the 1811W looks more attractive with its piano black glossy finish on the bezel and the rear side. There is a transparent projection running around the bezel as compared to the ordinary bezel of the 1810W. We noticed that the bezel around the 1810W was of poor quality and tends to bend outwards exposing a minute gap under pressure. The stand appears sturdier than that on the 1811W.

PERFORMANCE

Acer S191HQL gave a good contrast ratio and this showed in the HD movie viewing where colour rendition was quite good and there was hardly any noise. We did notice some backlight bleeding in some dark scenes. The reflective screen is the biggest handicap of this otherwise good display. In Display Mate tests, the grey transition was strictly OK but we didn't notice any colour casts, which a good sign. Even at 16-ramp intensity levels, no colour tinge was observed. Reverse text readability test was quite poor as we couldn't read green on cyan, magenta on red, yellow on white and yellow on green. Viewing angles for movies was not that great. Text readability in the Pix-perAn scored the maximum.

NEC EA191M had the best contrast ratio on all three brightness settings with excellent black levels at 0 brightness, which was not the case with



NEC MultiSync EA191M won the Best Performer for its consistently good performance across all the benchmarks and a great contrast ratio